

GUIDELINES FOR THE SACRAMENT OF EUCHARIST IN OUR PARISH

A. Registration and Preparation

Children who complete eight years of age during the relevant calendar year may register at the Parish Office for First Holy Communion, subject to the parish's catechetical requirements.

Parents must actively participate in the preparation programme.

At least four meetings with parents shall be conducted to discuss, prepare and plan for the celebration of First Holy Communion.

The parish conducts special preparation classes during the Diwali and Christmas vacation periods. Attendance at these classes is compulsory.

Therefore, parents are requested not to plan outside trips, picnics or vacations during these prescribed preparation periods, as the children's attendance is essential for their sacramental preparation.

Children shall receive appropriate catechetical instruction about:

Jesus Christ

The Holy Eucharist

The Holy Mass

The Real Presence of Christ

Receiving Holy Communion worthily

Christian life and responsibility

The child should have sufficient understanding of the Eucharist appropriate to his or her age.

The child should know the required prayers by heart before receiving First Holy Communion. Parents have the primary responsibility of helping the child learn and practise these prayers at home.

B. Family and Spiritual Preparation

Parents are encouraged to make family prayer an important part of their daily life.

Parents should encourage their children to pray the Holy Rosary regularly and participate actively in family prayer.

Parents should bring their children regularly to Sunday Mass and help them develop a love for the Eucharist.

Parents should be good examples of Christian living, prayer and participation in the sacramental life of the Church.

Parents are encouraged to create an environment at home that helps the child grow in faith and understand the importance of receiving Jesus in the Holy Eucharist.

C. Celebration

First Holy Communion shall be celebrated with reverence, dignity and appropriate simplicity.

Parents and children shall be instructed beforehand regarding appropriate dress, conduct, participation and reverence during the celebration.

Photography and video recording should not interfere with the liturgy or distract the children and congregation from the sacred celebration.